

一、文章主旨

中文主旨

本文围绕美国铁路行业大规模合并、形成超级运输系统的现象展开，分别呈现了合并支持者的利好观点、托运商的受困处境与不满，解析了行业整合后的定价现状与申诉困境，阐述了铁路方对差别定价的理论辩解及外界质疑，最终指出托运商对并购成本转嫁、运费大幅上涨的担忧，全面探讨了铁路行业整合带来的垄断争议与市场影响。

英文主旨

This article focuses on the large-scale mergers in the American railroad industry and the formation of supersystems. It presents the favorable views of merger supporters, the difficult situation and dissatisfaction of shippers, analyzes the pricing status and appeal dilemma after industry consolidation, explains the theoretical justification of rate discrimination from railroads and external doubts, and finally points out shippers' worries about the transfer of merger costs and sharp rate increases, comprehensively discussing the monopoly disputes and market impacts brought by railroad industry consolidation.

二、逐段精读解析

第一段

1. **原句：** In recent years, railroads have been combining with each other, merging into supersystems, causing heightened concerns about monopoly.

◦ 翻译：近年来，铁路公司纷纷彼此合并，组建成为超级系统，这引发了人们对垄断问题的日益担忧。

◦ 常考单词/短语：

- combine with 与.....联合、合并
- merge into 合并为、融入
- supersystem n. 超级系统
- heightened adj. 加剧的、增强的
- monopoly n. 垄断；垄断经营者

2. **原句：** As recently as 1995, the top four railroads accounted for under 70 percent of the total ton-miles moved by rails.

◦ 翻译：就在1995年，四家头部铁路公司的运输量还不到铁路行业总运输吨英里数的70%。

◦ 常考单词/短语：

- as recently as 就在（最近的某个时间点）
- account for （在比例、数量上）占；解释
- ton-mile n. 吨英里（货运计量单位，指1吨货物运送1英里的运量）

3. **原句：** Next year, after a series of mergers is completed, just four railroads will control well over 90 percent of all the freight moved by major rail carriers.

◦ 翻译：到明年，在一系列合并完成后，仅四家铁路公司就将掌控主要铁路承运商货运总量的90%以上。

◦ 常考单词/短语：

- a series of 一系列的
- well over 远远超过、大大超出
- freight n. 货运；货物；运费
- carrier n. 承运商；运输公司

本段概括

本段通过1995年与次年的行业数据对比，直观展现了铁路行业加速合并、市场集中度大幅提升的现状，点明该现象引发了大众对垄断问题的担忧，引出全文核心话题。

第二段

1. **原句**: Supporters of the new supersystems argue that these mergers will allow for substantial cost reductions and better coordinated service.

◦ 翻译: 这类新型超级系统的支持者认为, 这些合并能够实现大幅的成本削减, 并且提供更协调统一的服务。

◦ 常考单词/短语:

- argue that 主张、认为
- allow for 使.....成为可能; 考虑到
- substantial adj. 大量的; 实质的
- cost reduction 成本降低
- coordinated adj. 协调的、协同的

2. **原句**: Any threat of monopoly, they argue, is removed by fierce competition from trucks.

◦ 翻译: 他们表示, 来自公路货运的激烈竞争已经完全消除了垄断带来的威胁。

◦ 常考单词/短语:

- remove v. 消除; 移除
- fierce competition 激烈的竞争
- truck n. 卡车; 此处指代公路货运

3. **原句**: But many shippers complain that for heavy bulk commodities traveling long distances, such as coal, chemicals, and grain, trucking is too costly and the railroads therefore have them by the throat.

◦ 翻译: 但许多托运商抱怨称, 对于煤炭、化工产品、粮食这类需要长途运输的大宗货物而言, 公路货运成本过高, 因此铁路公司完全扼住了他们的咽喉。

◦ **长难句分析**: 本句为主从复合句。主句为 many shippers complain that..., that引导宾语从句; 宾语从句内部, for heavy bulk commodities traveling long distances 作状语, such as... 为插入语举例说明大宗商品, 最后由and连接两个并列分句 trucking is too costly 与 the railroads therefore have them by the throat。

◦ 常考单词/短语:

- shipper n. 托运商、发货人
- bulk commodity 大宗商品、散装货物
- chemical n. 化工产品; adj. 化学的
- grain n. 谷物、粮食
- costly adj. 昂贵的、代价高的
- have sb. by the throat 扼住某人的咽喉、完全掌控某人

本段概括

本段呈现了针对铁路合并的两种对立观点: 支持者认为合并可降本增效, 且公路货运的竞争足以消解垄断风险; 托运商则指出大宗长途货物高度依赖铁路, 公路货运成本过高, 自身完全被铁路公司牵制。

第三段

1. **原句**: The vast consolidation within the rail industry means that most shippers are served by only one rail company.

◦ 翻译: 铁路行业的大规模整合意味着, 大多数托运商只能由一家铁路公司提供运输服务。

◦ 常考单词/短语:

- vast adj. 巨大的、大规模的
- consolidation n. 整合、合并
- serve v. 为.....提供服务

2. **原句**: Railroads typically charge such "captive" shippers 20 to 30 percent more than they do when another railroad is competing for the business.

◦ 翻译: 通常情况下, 铁路公司向这类“受牵制的”托运商收取的费用, 要比有其他铁路公司竞争同一项业务时高出20%到30%。

◦ **长难句分析**: 本句包含比较状语结构。句子主干为 Railroads charge such "captive" shippers 20 to 30 percent more; than引导比较状语, 其中 they do 指代前文的 charge shippers, 避免重复; when引导时间状语从句, 说明比较的参照场景 (有竞争的情况)。

◦ 常考单词/短语:

- typically adv. 通常、典型地
- charge v. 收费; 指控

- captive adj. 受控制的、受牵制的; n. 俘虏
- compete for 争夺、竞争

3. **原句:** Shippers who feel they are being overcharged have the right to appeal to the federal government's Surface Transportation Board for rate relief, but the process is expensive, time consuming, and will work only in truly extreme cases.

- 翻译: 认为自己被超额收费的托运商, 有权向联邦政府的地面运输委员会申诉以申请费率减免, 但这一流程成本高昂、耗时漫长, 且仅在真正极端的案例中才会生效。
- **长难句分析:** 本句是but连接的并列复合句。前一分句主干为 Shippers have the right to appeal... for rate relief; who引导定语从句修饰主语Shippers, 定语从句中还嵌套宾语从句 they are being overcharged。后一分句描述申诉流程的特点, expensive、time consuming 与 will work only in truly extreme cases 并列说明流程的属性。
- 常考单词/短语:
 - overcharge v. 多收费、索价过高
 - appeal to 向.....申诉; 对.....有吸引力
 - Surface Transportation Board 地面运输委员会 (美国联邦交通监管机构)
 - rate relief 费率减免
 - time consuming 耗时的
 - extreme case 极端案例

本段概括

本段说明行业高度整合后, 多数托运商成为仅受一家铁路公司服务的“受牵制客户”, 面临更高的收费; 同时指出托运商的官方申诉救济渠道存在成本高、耗时长、适用范围极窄的问题, 实际救济效果有限。

第四段

1. **原句:** Railroads justify rate discrimination against captive shippers on the grounds that in the long run it reduces everyone's cost.

- 翻译: 铁路公司为针对受牵制托运商的费率差别定价辩护, 理由是从长远来看, 这种做法会降低所有客户的成本。
- **长难句分析:** 主句为 Railroads justify rate discrimination against captive shippers; on the grounds that 引导原因状语从句, 说明辩护的核心理由, 从句中代词it指代前文的 rate discrimination (费率歧视/差别定价)。
- 常考单词/短语:
 - justify v. 证明.....合理; 为.....辩护
 - rate discrimination 费率歧视、差别定价
 - on the grounds that 理由是、基于.....依据
 - in the long run 从长远来看

2. **原句:** If railroads charged all customers the same average rate, they argue, shippers who have the option of switching to trucks or other forms of transportation would do so, leaving remaining customers to shoulder the cost of keeping up the line.

- 翻译: 他们提出, 如果铁路公司向所有客户收取相同的平均费率, 那些可以选择转向公路货运或其他运输方式的托运商就会这么做, 最终让剩余的客户承担维持铁路线路运营的成本。
- **长难句分析:** 本句为包含虚拟语气的复合句。they argue 是插入语; if引导对现在情况的虚拟条件状语从句, 从句谓语用过去式 charged; 主句主语为 shippers, 后接who引导的定语从句, 主句谓语为 would do so; 句末 leaving remaining customers... 是现在分词短语作结果状语。
- 常考单词/短语:
 - average rate 平均费率
 - have the option of 拥有.....的选择权
 - switch to 转向、切换到
 - shoulder the cost 承担成本
 - keep up the line 维持线路运营

3. **原句:** It's a theory to which many economists subscribe, but in practice it often leaves railroads in the position of determining which companies will flourish and which will fail.

- 翻译: 这一理论得到了许多经济学家的认同, 但在实际运营中, 这往往让铁路公司拥有了决定企业兴衰存亡的权力。
- **长难句分析:** 本句由but连接两个并列分句。前一分句包含“介词+关系代词”引导的定语从句 to which many economists subscribe, 修饰先行词theory, subscribe to the theory 为固定搭配, 意为“认同该理论”。后一分句中, determining 后接两个并列的宾语从句 which companies will flourish 与 which will fail。
- 常考单词/短语:
 - subscribe to 同意、认同; 订阅

- in practice 在实践中、实际上
- flourish v. 繁荣、兴旺发展
- in the position of 处于……的位置

4. **原句**: “Do we really want railroads to be the arbiters of who wins and who loses in the marketplace?” asks Martin Bercovici, a Washington lawyer who frequently represents shippers.

- 翻译: “我们真的希望铁路公司成为市场中决定成败的仲裁者吗?”经常代理托运商案件的华盛顿律师马丁·贝尔科维奇如是问道。
- **长难句分析**: 本句为倒装句, 直接引语前置, 主句主谓倒装 asks Martin Bercovici; a Washington lawyer... 是同位语, 解释说明Martin Bercovici的身份; 句末who引导定语从句, 修饰先行词lawyer。
- 常考单词/短语:
 - arbiter n. 仲裁者、裁决人
 - marketplace n. 市场
 - frequently adv. 频繁地、经常
 - represent v. 代理; 代表

本段概括

本段阐述了铁路公司对差别定价的核心理由——长远来看能降低整体成本, 该逻辑虽获得部分经济学家认可, 但实际赋予了铁路公司决定企业兴衰的市场权力, 引发了托运商代理律师的质疑与批判。

第五段

1. **原句**: Many captive shippers also worry they will soon be hit with a round of huge rate increases.

- 翻译: 许多受牵制的托运商还担心, 他们很快将面临一轮大幅的运费上涨。
- 常考单词/短语:
 - be hit with 遭受、面临
 - a round of 一轮
 - rate increase 费率上涨

2. **原句**: The railroad industry as a whole, despite its brightening fortunes, still does not earn enough to cover the cost of the capital it must invest to keep up with its surging traffic.

- 翻译: 整体来看, 尽管铁路行业的经营境况日渐向好, 但其盈利仍不足以覆盖为匹配激增的运输量而必须投入的资本成本。
- **长难句分析**: 主句为 The railroad industry still does not earn enough to cover the cost of the capital; despite its brightening fortunes 是插入的让步状语; it must invest... 是省略了关系代词的定语从句, 修饰先行词capital; to keep up with its surging traffic 是目的状语, 说明投资的目的。
- 常考单词/短语:
 - as a whole 整体来看
 - brightening adj. 渐好的、向好的
 - fortune n. 境况、财富
 - cover the cost 覆盖成本、支付费用
 - capital n. 资本
 - keep up with 跟上、匹配
 - surging adj. 激增的、汹涌的
 - traffic n. 运输量; 交通

3. **原句**: Yet railroads continue to borrow billions to acquire one another, with Wall Street cheering them on.

- 翻译: 然而铁路公司仍在借贷数十亿美元进行互相收购, 华尔街也对此持支持、追捧态度。
- 常考单词/短语:
 - acquire v. 收购、获得
 - Wall Street 华尔街 (代指美国金融界)
 - cheer on 鼓励、为……喝彩

4. **原句**: Consider the \$10.2 billion bid by Norfolk Southern and CSX to acquire Conrail this year.

- 翻译: 不妨看看今年诺福克南方公司与CSX公司出资102亿美元收购联合铁路公司的案例。
- 常考单词/短语:
 - bid n. 出价、收购要约
 - acquire v. 收购

5. **原句:** Conrail's net railway operating income in 1996 was just \$427 million, less than half of the carrying costs of the transaction.
- 翻译: 1996年联合铁路公司的铁路运营净收入仅为4.27亿美元, 还不到这笔交易执行成本的一半。
 - 常考单词/短语:
 - net operating income 净运营收入
 - carrying cost 执行成本、持有成本
 - transaction n. 交易
6. **原句:** Who's going to pay for the rest of the bill?
- 翻译: 剩下的账单要由谁来买单?
 - 常考单词/短语:
 - pay for 支付、为.....买单
 - bill n. 账单、费用
7. **原句:** Many captive shippers fear that they will, as Norfolk Southern and CSX increase their grip on the market.
- 翻译: 许多受牵制的托运商担心, 随着诺福克南方公司与CSX公司进一步掌控市场, 这笔成本将落到他们自己头上。
 - 常考单词/短语:
 - grip n. 掌控、控制
 - increase one's grip on 加强对.....的控制

本段概括

本段指出托运商的另一重担忧: 铁路行业自身盈利不足以覆盖业务扩张的资本成本, 却仍斥巨资借贷并购, 最终并购产生的成本缺口很可能通过涨运费的方式转嫁到受牵制的托运商身上。

三、完整原文

In recent years, railroads have been combining with each other, merging into supersystems, causing heightened concerns about monopoly. As recently as 1995, the top four railroads accounted for under 70 percent of the total ton-miles moved by rails. Next year, after a series of mergers is completed, just four railroads will control well over 90 percent of all the freight moved by major rail carriers.

Supporters of the new supersystems argue that these mergers will allow for substantial cost reductions and better coordinated service. Any threat of monopoly, they argue, is removed by fierce competition from trucks. But many shippers complain that for heavy bulk commodities traveling long distances, such as coal, chemicals, and grain, trucking is too costly and the railroads therefore have them by the throat.

The vast consolidation within the rail industry means that most shippers are served by only one rail company. Railroads typically charge such "captive" shippers 20 to 30 percent more than they do when another railroad is competing for the business. Shippers who feel they are being overcharged have the right to appeal to the federal government's Surface Transportation Board for rate relief, but the process is expensive, time consuming, and will work only in truly extreme cases.

Railroads justify rate discrimination against captive shippers on the grounds that in the long run it reduces everyone's cost. If railroads charged all customers the same average rate, they argue, shippers who have the option of switching to trucks or other forms of transportation would do so, leaving remaining customers to shoulder the cost of keeping up the line. It's a theory to which many economists subscribe, but in practice it often leaves railroads in the position of determining which companies will flourish and which will fail. "Do we really want railroads to be the arbiters of who wins and who loses in the marketplace?" asks Martin Bercovici, a Washington lawyer who frequently represents shippers.

Many captive shippers also worry they will soon be hit with a round of huge rate increases. The railroad industry as a whole, despite its brightening fortunes, still does not earn enough to cover the cost of the capital it must invest to keep up with its surging traffic. Yet railroads continue to borrow billions to acquire one another, with Wall Street cheering them on. Consider the 10.2 billion bid by Norfolk Southern and CSX to acquire Conrail this year. Conrail's net railway operating income in 1996 was just 427 million, less than half of the carrying costs of the transaction. Who's going to pay for the rest of the bill? Many captive shippers fear that they will, as Norfolk Southern and CSX increase their grip on the market.

四、完整译文

近年来, 铁路公司纷纷彼此合并, 组建成为超级系统, 这引发了人们对垄断问题的日益担忧。就在1995年, 四家头部铁路公司的运输量还不到铁路行业总运输吨英里数的70%。到明年, 在一系列合并完成后, 仅四家铁路公司就将掌控主要铁路承运商货运总量的90%以上。

这类新型超级系统的支持者认为，这些合并能够实现大幅的成本削减，并且提供更协调统一的服务。他们表示，来自公路货运的激烈竞争已经完全消除了垄断带来的威胁。但许多托运商抱怨称，对于煤炭、化工产品、粮食这类需要长途运输的大宗货物而言，公路货运成本过高，因此铁路公司完全扼住了他们的咽喉。

铁路行业的大规模整合意味着，大多数托运商只能由一家铁路公司提供运输服务。通常情况下，铁路公司向这类“受牵制的”托运商收取的费用，要比有其他铁路公司竞争同一项业务时高出20%到30%。认为自己被超额收费的托运商，有权向联邦政府的地面运输委员会申诉以申请费率减免，但这一流程成本高昂、耗时漫长，且仅在真正极端的案例中才会生效。

铁路公司为针对受牵制托运商的费率差别定价辩护，理由是从长远来看，这种做法会降低所有客户的成本。他们提出，如果铁路公司向所有客户收取相同的平均费率，那些可以选择转向公路货运或其他运输方式的托运商就会这么做，最终让剩余的客户承担维持铁路线路运营的成本。这一理论得到了许多经济学家的认同，但在实际运营中，这往往让铁路公司拥有了决定企业兴衰存亡的权力。“我们真的希望铁路公司成为市场中决定成败的仲裁者吗？”经常代理托运商案件的华盛顿律师马丁·贝尔科维奇如是问道。

许多受牵制的托运商还担心，他们很快将面临一轮大幅的运费上涨。整体来看，尽管铁路行业的经营境况日渐向好，但其盈利仍不足以覆盖为匹配激增的运输量而必须投入的资本成本。然而铁路公司仍在借贷数十亿美元进行互相收购，华尔街也对此持支持、追捧态度。不妨看看今年诺福克南方公司与CSX公司出资102亿美元收购联合铁路公司的案例。1996年联合铁路公司的铁路运营净收入仅为4.27亿美元，还不到这笔交易执行成本的一半。剩下的账单要由谁来买单？许多受牵制的托运商担心，随着诺福克南方公司与CSX公司进一步掌控市场，这笔成本将落到他们自己头上。